

The deadlines moved. The work did not

Edition 3 in the Belastingdienst series. Previous Decision Intelligence briefing: 'The Deadlines Hardened, the Mandate Softened' (July 2026).

Cycle: 22 September 2026 · Audience: Senior strategy, execution, supervision and IV leadership · Horizon: 6 to 18 months primary, 2 to 5 years secondary

Read estimate: 6 min Executive Synthesis · 27 min full read

What you will learn

1. Why a postponed programme costs more than a cancelled one, and who pays for the difference
2. What happened when the one deadline that held arrived, and why the receipts went somewhere else
3. Which of this administration's dates are fixed in law and which are a negotiating position

Key takeaways

1. Three of the four deadlines that framed the July cycle moved; the fourth reshaped the trade it taxed
2. E-commerce customs declarations fell 46% and their item lines 70% in the two months after 1 July
3. The AI Act high-risk date moved to 2 December 2027, and none of the constraints that actually bind moved

Why This Matters Now

Four dates governed this organisation's plan in July. Three of them have since moved. The tax on actual investment returns, due to start in 2028, is now waiting on a coalition decision deferred to next spring. The European deadline that was to force the clean-up of automated selection slipped by sixteen months. A promise to simplify five hundred rules a year had already been missed before it was written into a bill.

The fourth date held. On 1 July the European Union began charging duty on small parcels. Within two months the parcels stopped arriving as parcels: customs declarations fell by nearly half, and the item lines inside them by seven-tenths, as goods were consolidated into European warehouses and sent on from there. The charge changed the route rather than the receipts.

The one thing to take into the next meeting: when a deadline moves, the work behind it does not disappear. It becomes undated. Undated work cannot be staffed, sequenced or stopped, and it is the most expensive kind an organisation can hold.

Executive Synthesis

Which of the dates in your 2027 plan are fixed, and which are somebody else's opening position?

Three of the four deadlines this administration was planning against moved within ten weeks, and the only one that held redirected the flow it was designed to tax.

The Belastingdienst spent this quarter losing its calendar. On 30 June the Eerste Kamer held over its vote on the Wet werkelijk rendement box 3 until the cabinet produces the novelle it had promised ([Eerste Kamer](#), Jun 2026). On 11 September the decision moved again, to the Voorjaarsnota, because the three coalition parties could not agree what to change or how to pay for it: in Dutch, “D66, VVD en CDA zijn er na verder overleg niet in geslaagd overeenstemming te bereiken over aanpassingen van de belasting op sparen en beleggen en de miljarden dekking daarvoor.”, which reads in English as “D66, VVD and CDA have not succeeded, after further discussion, in reaching agreement on adjustments to the tax on saving and investing and on the billions in funding for it” ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026). The Belastingplan 2027 package tabled on Prinsjesdag contains no box 3 measure at all ([Rijksoverheid](#), Sep 2026), while the government's own explainer page, last revised on 29 July, still tells readers the repair will be in that package and that the new system begins on 1 January 2028 ([Rijksoverheid](#), Jul 2026). Three official positions, none reconciled, and a programme that can now be neither cancelled nor committed.

The same quarter moved a second date. The obligation that framed our July edition, EU AI Act high-risk duties falling on public-authority enforcement systems from 2 August 2026, was postponed by sixteen months when ([Regulation \(EU\) 2026/1744](#), Jul 2026)

entered into force on 27 July, shifting Annex III systems to 2 December 2027 and Annex I to 2 August 2028 ([the European Commission](#), Jul 2026). And a third: the cabinet's pledge of an annual Vereenvoudigingswet stripping at least five hundred rules a year ([the Troonrede](#), Sep 2026) arrived three months after a ministerial letter reported that the first such target had been missed, at rather more than four hundred ([Financieel Management](#), Jun 2026).

One date held, and it is the instructive one. The abolition of the EUR 150 customs de-minimis and the interim EUR 3 duty took effect on 1 July exactly as the Council legislated in February ([the Council of the EU](#), Feb 2026). Two months later the Douane reported in Dutch, “In juli en augustus zag Douane Nederland het gemiddelde aantal aangiften e-commerce afnemen met 46% ten opzichte van het gemiddelde aantal van de eerste 6 maanden van 2026. Tegelijkertijd daalde het aantal aangifteregels e-commerce met 70%.”, which reads in English as “In July and August Douane Nederland saw the average number of e-commerce declarations fall by 46% against the average for the first 6 months of 2026. At the same time the number of e-commerce declaration lines fell by 70%” ([Douane Nederland](#), Sep 2026). Regular declarations rose 20% and their lines 30% over the same period. Nothing was smuggled and nothing stopped: the goods were consolidated into warehouses inside the European Union and despatched from there, a pattern French customs and Belgian trade reporting both show ([Euronews](#), Aug 2026) ([Flows](#), Aug 2026). The measure that arrived on time did not raise the revenue it was aimed at. It moved the traffic.

A postponed programme does not release the people held against it. It converts them into a standing reserve for work that nobody has yet authorised.

What did not move is the work. To 19 August the Belastingdienst had received 863,600 objection forms under the box 3 tegenbewijsregeling, up some 60,000 in the ten weeks since 8 June, with 537,800 substantively processed and EUR 969 million repaid against the EUR 16.6 billion successive cabinets had reserved ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026) ([Taxence](#), Jul 2026). Roughly 700 full-time staff are engaged on it and the operation is expected to run until at least 2030. In the Senate debate the uitvoeringstoets for the new system was put on the record as requiring in Dutch, “De uitvoeringstoets laat zien dat het stelsel een enorme belasting legt op de Belastingdienst. We hebben het niet over een paar extra medewerkers. Nee, we hebben het over bijna 900 extra fte structureel, boven op de bestaande wervingsopgave.”, which reads in English as “The implementation assessment shows that the system places an

enormous burden on the Belastingdienst. We are not talking about a few extra staff. No, we are talking about nearly 900 extra FTE structurally, on top of the existing recruitment task” ([Eerste Kamer, Handelingen](#), Jun 2026). Postponement subtracts nothing from either number. It only removes the date against which they could be planned.

Underneath sits the constraint the Algemene Rekenkamer named in May: in Dutch, “Deze systemen zijn nodig om € 233,6 miljard aan belastingen en premies te heffen. Het risico ontstaat dat de Belastingdienst deze ontvangsten niet kan heffen wanneer deze systemen op den duur het heffingsproces niet meer kunnen ondersteunen.”, which reads in English as “These systems are needed to levy EUR 233.6 billion in taxes and contributions. The risk arises that the Belastingdienst cannot levy these receipts when in time these systems can no longer support the levying process” ([the Algemene Rekenkamer](#), May 2026). That is the machine on which a deferred reform, a missed simplification target, an algorithm remediation programme whose external deadline has just slipped, and a 2030 e-invoicing mandate that has not slipped, all have to be sequenced. The Belastingdienst's own Stand van de uitvoering is unusually direct about where the lever sits: in Dutch, “De Belastingdienst kan dit niet alleen oplossen. Veel knelpunten hebben hun oorsprong in wet- en regelgeving en vereisen daarom politieke keuzes.”, which reads in English as “The Belastingdienst cannot solve this alone. Many bottlenecks have their origin in legislation and regulation and therefore require political choices” ([the Belastingdienst](#), Jun 2026).

Where this analysis could be wrong

Delay is the normal condition of Dutch tax legislation, and the organisation has absorbed it before. Dates have slipped on box 3 since the 2021 Hoge Raad ruling without collection failing, and an argument that this particular slip is different has to carry that history. The honest form of our claim is narrower than the headline: the cost is not the delay, it is the combination of an undated build with a legacy tail that is independently committed to 2030.

Two of our load-bearing numbers reach us at one remove. The figure of nearly 900 extra FTE comes from a senator quoting the uitvoeringstoets on the floor of the Eerste Kamer, not from the document, whose PDF we could not open. The EUR 2.4 billion to EUR 2.5 billion of annual revenue said to be at stake rests on leaked Prinsjesdag papers and unnamed sources in two outlets ([Taxence](#), Sep 2026) ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026), not on a published raming. We also record a trap we came close to walking into: EUR 2.4 billion a year is separately the reported cost of the tegenbewijsregeling itself ([Eerste Kamer, Handelingen](#), Jun 2026). The two figures coincide by accident and mean different things.

The customs finding is two months old, and the comparisons do not converge. July and August are measured against a six-month average that includes no summer. The Netherlands reports a 46% fall in *declarations*; NOS rendered the same figure as a fall in *parcels* ([NOS](#), Sep 2026); Belgium reports 35% of low-value Chinese imports ([Flows](#), Aug 2026) and French customs 30% to 40% of parcels ([Euronews](#), Aug 2026). These are different quantities over different periods and we have not averaged them. France is also not a clean control: it levied its own EUR 2 per-article parcel tax from 1 March 2026, repealed when the EU duty began ([French customs](#), Jul 2026).

The decisions that cannot be deferred this cycle

1. **Put a date on the undated.** Decide now what the box 3 build does between today and the Voorjaarsnota, rather than holding it ready.
2. **Stop treating the AI Act as the clock.** The court exposure and the AP's conditions run on national law, which did not move by sixteen months.
3. **Read the parcel numbers as a demand signal, not a revenue one.** The line count, not the declaration count, is what the November handling fee will be charged against.

4. **Book the 2030 e-invoicing decision into 2027.** Parliamentary handling has to be finished by 1 July 2028, which makes this a present-tense commitment.

Each is developed below, with a decision posture, in the four Strategic Implications.

Continuity ledger: what the July edition said and what happened

Four theses were published on 15 July with the conditions that would weaken each one written into them. Two of those conditions have since been met. This is the grading.

What July claimed	Verdict	What happened
The e-commerce customs shock	Overtured	July's thesis carried an explicit condition: it would weaken "only if post-reform parcel volumes fell materially". They fell. E-commerce declarations are down 46% and their item lines down 70% (Douane Nederland , Sep 2026). We also graded this Near-Term. On the evidence it was Immediate, and the tiering was ours to get right.
The algorithmic legitimacy cliff	Overtured	The thesis rested on 2 August 2026 as a hard date and said it would weaken if a formal transitional instrument reached public-authority enforcement AI. (Regulation (EU) 2026/1744 , Jul 2026) did not exempt it; it postponed the whole Annex III regime to 2 December 2027 (the European Commission , Jul 2026). The premise date no longer exists.
Box 3 and the audited capacity crunch	Strengthened	The condition for weakening was the 2026 audit closing imperfections rather than adding them; it added them (the Algemene Rekenkamer , May 2026). Since then the bill has been held over (Eerste Kamer , Jun 2026), the objection inflow has not stopped (Accountancy Vanmorgen , Sep 2026), and the Senate put the uitvoeringstoets figure on the public record (Eerste Kamer, Handelingen , Jun 2026).

The GenAI-first taxpayer and embedded tax

Weakened

Directionally right, wrongly located. The shift this cycle is not in the taxpayer but in the intermediary: around 80% of junior tax advisers now use AI daily ([Accountant.nl](#), Sep 2026). The taxpayer-facing case remains gated behind the legitimacy bar, exactly as July argued.

The July title: 'The Deadlines Hardened, the Mandate Softened'

Overtaken

Both halves inverted within one quarter. The deadlines softened, by sixteen months on the AI Act and indefinitely on box 3, while the mandate hardened into a numeric annual simplification quota ([the Troonrede](#), Sep 2026).

Audience Snapshots

Four lenses on the same evidence base. Each card surfaces the one question this cycle puts to that reader.

You are now planning against one fixed date and three negotiations

The shift: Only the EU customs and e-invoicing timetables are outside the coalition's gift. Box 3 has moved to the Voorjaarsnota ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026), the AI Act high-risk date to December 2027 ([the European Commission](#), Jul 2026), and the simplification pledge arrived already behind its own number ([Financieel Management](#), Jun 2026).

The question to brief: Which of our 2027 commitments assume a date that a minister can move, and what is the standing cost of holding each one ready?

Sixteen months of slack has appeared in a portfolio that has no slack

The shift: The AI Act postponement releases pressure on remediation at the same moment the 2030 e-invoicing mandate becomes a present-tense build ([Rijksoverheid](#), Sep 2026), against an estate the Rekenkamer says may eventually fail to support the levying process ([the Algemene Rekenkamer](#), May 2026).

The question to brief: Is the AI Act slack being reallocated deliberately, or is it simply being absorbed by whatever is loudest this quarter?

TOEZICHT & HANDHAVING

Your constraint was never the European deadline

The shift: The AP's 2 September decision permits bias testing on special-category data only as a temporary measure and requires a permanent alternative to be pursued alongside it ([Computable](#), Sep 2026), while courts have begun annulling decisions elsewhere in government for unexplained algorithmic selection ([Follow the Money](#), Jun 2026).

The question to brief: If the AI Act's high-risk date had never existed, what in our remediation plan would change? If the answer is nothing, why was it the plan's organising date?

CFO / DOUANE

The tax base moved rather than grew, and the next charge is priced per line

The shift: The EUR 3 duty produced around EUR 35 million in July ([NOS](#), Sep 2026) while e-commerce declaration lines fell 70% ([Douane Nederland](#), Sep 2026). The European handling fee arriving on 1 November is in Dutch, "De handling fee wordt 2 euro per aangifteregel in de bestelling.", which reads in English as "The handling fee will be 2 euros per declaration line in the order" ([Thuiswinkel.org](#), Jun 2026).

The question to brief: What is our forecast for handling-fee receipts built on, given that the quantity it is charged against has fallen by seven-tenths in two months?

Themes

The cycle's signals are organised into six themes, ranked by impact on near-term decisions.

Immediate: changes the near-term plan, the structure or the proposition. **Near-Term:** changes position over the next twelve months. **Longer-Range:** a multi-year factor to track and revisit each cycle.

1. Postponing Box 3 does not give the capacity back

IMMEDIATE

The reform that has organised this administration's planning for four years now has no date. The Wet werkelijk rendement box 3 passed the Tweede Kamer on 12 February. On 30 June the Eerste Kamer, rather than voting it down, held the vote over until the cabinet delivers the novelle it promised ([Eerste Kamer](#), Jun 2026). On 11 September the cabinet declined to deliver it and moved the decision to the Voorjaarsnota ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026). The bill is therefore alive, unpassed and unscheduled at once, which is the single most expensive state a large programme can occupy. It cannot be stopped, so its people cannot be released. It cannot be committed, so its work cannot begin.

Where four deadlines stood in July, and where they stand now



Three of the four dates that framed the July cycle have moved. The one that held is the one nobody described as reform.

- The Belastingplan 2027 package tabled on Prinsjesdag contains no box 3 measure ([Rijksoverheid](#), Sep 2026), although the government's own explainer page, last revised 29 July, still states that any repair will be in that package and that the system starts on 1 January 2028 ([Rijksoverheid](#), Jul 2026).
- The legacy tail is independent of the new system and is growing. To 19 August the Belastingdienst had received 863,600 objection forms under the tegenbewijsregeling, against 804,411 on 8 June, with 537,800 substantively processed ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026). Around 700 full-time staff are engaged and the operation is expected to run until at least 2030 ([Taxence](#), Jul 2026).
- Against EUR 16.6 billion reserved by successive cabinets for box 3 restoration, EUR 969 million has been repaid ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026). The underspend is not a saving. It is a measure of how much processing has not yet happened.
- In the Senate debate the uitvoeringstoets for the new system was quoted as requiring nearly 900 additional full-time staff on top of the existing recruitment task, with the tegenbewijsregeling separately said to absorb close to 2,000 more ([Eerste Kamer](#), [Handelingen](#), Jun 2026).
- The postponement does not stay inside box 3. From 2028 the zorgtoeslag wealth limits were to be set equal to the heffingsvrij vermogen in box 3, and the deduction for specifieke zorgkosten abolished ([PwC](#), Jan 2026). Dienst Toeslagen's 2028 build now depends on a parameter of a bill nobody can schedule.

Early indicators

- **WEAK SIGNAL** The cabinet is researching a vermogenswinstbelasting in parallel. A realisation-based system is not a softened version of the current bill but a different machine, with a different data supply and a different uitvoeringstoets ([Rijksoverheid](#), Jul 2026). If that is where the Voorjaarsnota lands, the 900 FTE figure is a floor rather than an estimate.

Counter-argument

Dates have slipped on box 3 since 2021 without collection failing, and an organisation that has absorbed five years of slippage will absorb a sixth. That is fair, and it is why the claim here is narrower than the headline: the cost is not the delay but the collision of an undated build with a legacy operation already committed to 2030. The thesis would weaken if the Voorjaarsnota produced a dated decision that the Eerste Kamer accepted without a further novelle.

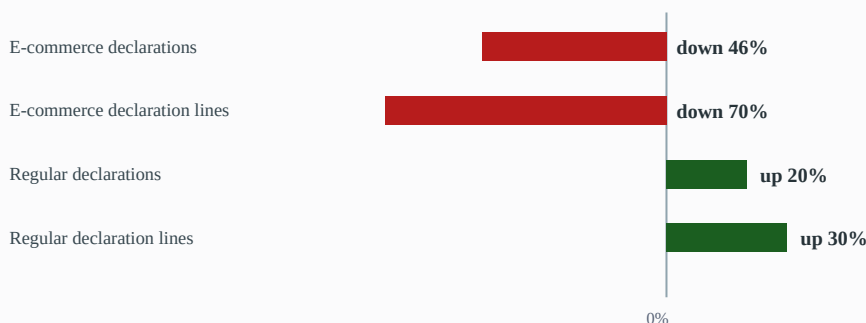
Decision link: SI 1. The question is not when box 3 starts, but what the build does between now and the Voorjaarsnota.

2. The new parcel charge moved the parcels, not the revenue

IMMEDIATE

On 1 July the European Union abolished the EUR 150 customs de-minimis and began levying an interim flat duty of EUR 3, charged per item category rather than per parcel, running to 1 July 2028 ([the Council of the EU](#), Feb 2026) ([the European Commission](#), Jun 2026). It is the only deadline in this cycle that arrived on the day it was legislated for, and it produced the cycle's most useful finding: a compliance instrument does not simply tax a flow, it reshapes it. Two months of Dutch data show the flow reshaping faster than any forecast contemplated.

Dutch customs volumes, July and August 2026 against the first half of the year



The European handling fee arriving on 1 November is charged per declaration line.

The parcels did not stop. They were consolidated into European warehouses and entered as bulk, which is why the two columns move in opposite directions.

- E-commerce declarations fell 46% in July and August against the average of the first six months of the year, and the item lines inside them fell 70%, while regular declarations rose 20% and their lines 30% ([Douane Nederland](#), Sep 2026).

- The mechanism is consolidation, not evasion. Non-EU retailers are importing in bulk into European warehouses and despatching to consumers from inside the customs union, a pattern the Douane says it also observes in France and Belgium ([Douane Nederland](#), Sep 2026).
- The platform response is uneven. Volume sales between June and July fell 50% at Temu and 37% at AliExpress but only 15% at Shein, which opened a Polish warehouse in late 2025 ([Euronews](#), Aug 2026). The charge is sorting platforms by whether they already hold EU capacity.
- The revenue is small and the baseline is unknown. The duty produced around EUR 35 million in the Netherlands in July ([NOS](#), Sep 2026). We could not locate any published forecast against which to judge that, and we do not present it as an overshoot or a shortfall.
- The next instrument is priced against the quantity that collapsed. From 1 November a European handling fee of EUR 2 applies to every declaration line ([Thuiswinkel.org](#), Jun 2026), and declaration lines are down 70%.

Early indicators

- **WEAK SIGNAL** **The interim duty has a scheduled successor, and it is a data system.** The EUR 3 rate is explicitly a placeholder until the EU customs data hub is operational, when normal tariffs resume ([the Council of the EU](#), Feb 2026). That converts a rate question into an integration question on the same 2028 horizon as everything else in this cycle.

Counter-argument

Two months is a short series, the comparison base excludes any previous summer, and the national figures do not converge: the Netherlands reports 46% on declarations, Belgium 35% on low-value Chinese imports ([Flows](#), Aug 2026) and French customs 30% to 40% on parcels ([Euronews](#), Aug 2026). France is also not a clean control, having levied its own EUR 2 per-article tax from 1 March 2026 until the EU duty replaced it ([French customs](#), Jul 2026). The thesis would weaken if declaration volumes recovered through the autumn peak without a matching rise in bulk import.

Decision link: SI 3. Forecast against the line count, not the declaration count.

3. The AI Act deadline moved to December 2027. The algorithm problem stayed.

IMMEDIATE

The July cycle built its second theme on 2 August 2026, the date EU AI Act high-risk obligations were to bind public-authority enforcement systems. That date is gone. ([Regulation \(EU\) 2026/1744](#), Jul 2026), adopted on 8 July and in force from 27 July, moved Annex III

systems to 2 December 2027 and Annex I to 2 August 2028 ([the European Commission](#), Jul 2026). Sixteen months of slack has appeared in a remediation programme that was being driven by the deadline. Nothing else that constrains the programme moved at all.

- The transparency duties took effect on schedule: in Dutch, “Artikel 50 van de AI-verordening is vanaf 2 augustus 2026 van toepassing.”, which reads in English as “Article 50 of the AI Regulation applies from 2 August 2026” ([PrimeLaw](#), Aug 2026), with a narrow carve-out postponing the marking requirement for generative systems already on the market to 2 December 2026 ([IT en Recht](#), Jul 2026).
- The national supervisor did not relax. On 2 September the AP permitted the Belastingdienst to process special-category data for bias and fairness testing, but only so far as strictly necessary, and in Dutch, “De AP benadrukt dat dit een tijdelijke oplossing is, benodigd voor de uitvoering van het Plan van Aanpak voor de toetsing van de geautomatiseerde selectie-instrumenten. Het is de bedoeling dat de Belastingdienst in de tussentijd op zoek gaat naar een structurele oplossing voor verwerking van (bijzondere) persoonsgegevens bij bias- en fairness-toetsing.”, which reads in English as “The AP stresses that this is a temporary solution, needed for the execution of the Action Plan for the assessment of the automated selection instruments. The intention is that in the meantime the Belastingdienst looks for a structural solution for processing (special categories of) personal data in bias and fairness testing” ([Computable](#), Sep 2026).
- The remediation programme has paperwork but no published deadline of its own. The Plan van aanpak Geautomatiseerde Selectie-instrumenten and the AP's assessment of it went to the Tweede Kamer in March ([the Ministerie van Financiën](#), Mar 2026), and the AP's September decision is framed entirely around executing that plan ([Computable](#), Sep 2026). No completion date attaches to either.
- The exposure runs through national administrative law, which did not move. After April and May rulings that the IND had insufficiently explained its CaseMatcher algorithm, [Follow the Money](#) argues the Belastingdienst faces the same risk across millions of decisions ([Follow the Money](#), Jun 2026).
- The register and the regulator do not describe the same estate. The national register lists 69 published algorithms, every one marked as in use ([the national algorithm register](#), accessed Sep 2026), while the Belastingdienst is reported to run at least 68, of which the AP found more than 50 unlawful and discriminatory ([Follow the Money](#), Jun 2026). Registered algorithms and automated selection instruments are different populations and we have not reconciled them.
- Dutch supervision itself is late. The draft Uitvoeringswet designates ten market surveillance authorities and the cabinet concedes it will enter into force later than the Regulation requires ([Binnenlands Bestuur](#), Apr 2026).

Early indicators

- **WEAK SIGNAL** **A temporary permission with no expiry date attached.** The AP's decision is explicitly temporary and conditional on pursuing a permanent alternative, possibly through experimenteerwetgeving ([Computable](#), Sep 2026). No date is attached to either the permission or the replacement. That is a second undated obligation, inside a programme that just lost its only dated one.

Counter-argument

Sixteen months of genuine slack in a portfolio the Rekenkamer describes as overloaded is a real gain, and treating a postponement as a risk can read as refusing good news. The distinction that matters is whether the slack is reallocated by decision or absorbed by default. The thesis would weaken if the Belastingdienst published a remediation plan with dates of its own, independent of the AI Act calendar.

Decision link: SI 2. Replace the external date with an internal one, or the programme has no clock.

4. The government has promised to simplify 500 rules a year

NEAR-TERM

The Troonrede of 15 September committed the cabinet to an annual Vereenvoudigingswet with a numeric target: at least five hundred rules disappearing or becoming simpler each year ([the Troonrede](#), Sep 2026). A counted annual target is a different kind of obligation from a policy intention. It is auditable, it recurs, and it competes for the same legislative and execution slots as everything already queued. Three facts about it were on the public record before it was announced.

- The target had already been missed. In a letter to the Tweede Kamer in June the minister reported that the cabinet had scrapped or simplified just over four hundred rules against the promised five hundred ([Financieel Management](#), Jun 2026).
- The instrument excludes the category the Belastingdienst's problems fall into. The Kamerbrief setting out the mechanism states in Dutch, “De wet is niet bedoeld voor grote stelselwijzigingen of politiek gevoelige onderwerpen.”, which reads in English as “The Act is not intended for major system changes or politically sensitive subjects” ([Rijksoverheid](#), Sep 2026).
- The first edition contains no fiscal content. It covers the Omgevingswet, the Burgerlijk Wetboek, the Energiewet, the Mijnbouwwet, offshore wind and student finance ([Rijksoverheid](#), Sep 2026), drawn from four ministries, of which Financiën is not one ([TaxLive](#), Sep 2026).

- The state's own legislative adviser recorded the contradiction on the same day. On the Belastingplan 2027 the Raad van State wrote in Dutch, “In het pakket Belastingplan 2027 worden een aantal maatregelen voorgesteld met het oog op vereenvoudiging van het belastingstelsel, waaronder aanpassing of afschaffing van enkele negatief geëvalueerde fiscale regelingen. Ook worden meerdere maatregelen voorgesteld die complexiteitsverhogend zijn.”, which reads in English as “A number of measures are proposed in the Belastingplan 2027 package with a view to simplifying the tax system, including the adjustment or abolition of several negatively evaluated fiscal arrangements. Multiple measures are also proposed that increase complexity” ([the Raad van State](#), Sep 2026), and noted Belastingdienst reservations about enforceability and fraud resistance.
- The same coalition agreement that promises the 500 also imposes an annual efficiency target on delivery organisations, of which only half may be reinvested in improvement ([the coalition agreement](#), Feb 2026).

Counter-argument

A shortfall of four hundred against five hundred in the first year of a new instrument is not a failure, and compressing consultation from six weeks to four is a genuine throughput gain. The objection is one of arithmetic rather than intent: a target counted in rules rewards removing many small ones, while the Belastingdienst's own bottlenecks are few and large. The thesis would weaken if the first Vereenvoudigingswet carried a fiscal chapter addressing a named knelpunt from the Stand van de uitvoering.

Decision link: SI 4. Get a Financiën chapter into the second edition, or the quota is somebody else's programme.

5. Tax advisers and neighbouring administrations automated first

NEAR-TERM

While Dutch automated selection sits under a conditional and temporary permission, the people on the other side of the assessment and the administrations across the border have been moving. The asymmetry is not primarily about capability. It is about who currently has permission to act, and the answer is: everybody else.

- A survey of 799 practitioners fielded in April found roughly 80% of junior tax advisers using AI daily, around 70% of mediors and 53% of seniors, with 60% among in-house corporate tax specialists ([Accountant.nl](#), Sep 2026).
- Governance has not kept up on that side either. Only about 25% of respondents report written AI guidelines in their firm ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026). The Belastingdienst is therefore meeting submissions prepared with tools their own preparers do not formally govern.

- North Rhine-Westphalia put self-developed AI risk selection into every one of its tax offices in spring 2026 and the component has been available across Germany since February ([the North Rhine-Westphalia tax administration](#), Jun 2026). The ministry's stated expectation: in German, "Landesweit rechnen wir im neuen Jahr mit rund 800.000 weniger Prüfhinweisen, weil die Künstliche Intelligenz gleichzeitig auch Fälle mit geringem Risiko anhand gut nachvollziehbarer Muster treffsicher identifiziert.", which reads in English as "Across the state we expect around 800,000 fewer audit flags in the new year, because the artificial intelligence simultaneously identifies low-risk cases accurately on the basis of clearly traceable patterns" ([dpa-AFX](#), Apr 2026).
- It won an award for it. The module took the Public Leadership Award in June 2026 ([the North Rhine-Westphalia tax administration](#), Jun 2026). The same class of automated selection that is restricted here is being held up as a model of responsible public sector AI next door.
- Berlin is following, with robotic process automation in the Uebernachtungsteuer unit since January and two AI research tools released to all tax office staff in May ([the Berlin Senate](#), Jul 2026).
- The direction is European, and so is the caveat. The Commission reports that 22% of its Technical Support Instrument projects target tax compliance and a further 21% the digitalisation of revenue administration, while stating that enforcement capacity cannot substitute for tax morale and public trust ([the European Commission](#), Jul 2026).

Early indicators

- **WEAK SIGNAL** **Germany separately shipped a one-click return, which is a different programme.** From 1 July 2026 around 11.5 million German citizens can file a pre-filled return with a preview of the assessment in a single action ([the state of North Rhine-Westphalia](#), Jun 2026). It is easy to read this and the risk-selection rollout as one story. They are two, and only one of them depends on selection algorithms.

Counter-argument

The Netherlands has specific reasons for caution that Germany does not, and the toeslagenaffaire is the reason. An administration that moved fast on automated selection and was found to have discriminated should be slower the second time. The honest question is not whether to be slower but whether the current pace is a chosen pace. The thesis would weaken if the AP's conditions were shown to be compatible with deployment at the scale NRW has reached.

Decision link: SI 2. The comparator is not last year's Belastingdienst, it is this year's Finanzamt.

6. E-invoicing in 2030 is a decision that has to be made now

LONGER-RANGE

One date in this cycle comes from EU law rather than from a coalition, and it has not moved. ([Council Directive \(EU\) 2025/516](#), Mar 2025) fixes the ViDA digital reporting regime from 1 July 2030. On 11 September the cabinet set the Dutch shape of it: mandatory B2B e-invoicing from 1 July 2030 and digital reporting to the Belastingdienst from 1 July 2031 ([Rijksoverheid](#), Sep 2026). The date that matters for this organisation is none of those three.

- Parliamentary handling has to be complete before 1 July 2028, with internet consultation starting this autumn and the bill expected before the 2027 summer recess ([Taxence](#), Sep 2026). That is the real deadline, and it falls inside the current planning period.
- Firms under the kleineondernemersregeling, with turnover up to EUR 20,000, are exempt from both obligations ([Rijksoverheid](#), Sep 2026), which means the reporting population has to be identified and maintained rather than assumed.
- Near-real-time reporting is a different machine from periodic returns. The EY research commissioned by the ministry recommends a phased introduction with substantial time between publication of the legislation and go-live ([EY](#), Mar 2026), and cites per-invoice cost savings of 55% to 70% against paper handling ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026).
- France is the live comparator and it is already running. From 1 September 2026 every French business in scope must be able to receive electronic invoices: in French, “À compter du 1er septembre 2026, toutes les entreprises concernées par la réforme doivent avoir la capacité de recevoir des factures électroniques.”, which reads in English as “From 1 September 2026, all businesses covered by the reform must have the capacity to receive electronic invoices” ([the French Direction generale des Finances publiques](#), Jul 2026), with small firms issuing from 1 September 2027.
- The receiving side is a systems project rather than a filing change, and Dutch business representatives are already describing it that way ([evofenedex](#), Sep 2026).

Counter-argument

2030 is four years out, the Belastingdienst has more urgent work, and building early against a standard still being specified wastes effort. That is right about the build and wrong about the decision: the architecture choice has to survive legislative scrutiny by mid-2028, which is two planning cycles away, not four. The thesis would weaken if the ViDA dates themselves slipped, which would put every deadline in this cycle in the same category.

Decision link: SI 4. Treat 1 July 2028 as the date, not 1 July 2030.

Strategic Implications

Four implications, each carrying a decision posture. This cycle produced no monitor-only implication, which is itself a finding: every one of the four has an action that is cheaper taken now than taken after the Voorjaarsnota.

SI 1: Decide what the box 3 build does between now and the Voorjaarsnota

The programme is alive, unpassed and unscheduled ([Eerste Kamer](#), Jun 2026) ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026). Held ready, it consumes architects, testers and legislative capacity at close to full cost while producing nothing; stood down, it cannot restart inside the window a spring decision would leave. The choice between those two is currently being made by default, quarter by quarter, by nobody in particular. The dependent builds make the default worse: Dienst Toeslagen's 2028 zorgtoeslag change is pegged to a box 3 parameter that no longer has a settled value ([PwC](#), Jan 2026).

Action: Name an accountable owner for the box 3 programme's holding state and publish, internally, what it will and will not do before the Voorjaarsnota. Attach a standing monthly cost to holding it ready, so that the next deferral is priced rather than absorbed.

DECIDE

Draws on Theme 1

SI 2: Give algorithm remediation a date of its own

The AI Act was never the binding constraint; it was the visible one. Its Annex III obligations moved to 2 December 2027 ([the European Commission](#), Jul 2026), while the AP's conditions, the national administrative-law exposure and the transparency duties that took effect on 2 August 2026 all stayed where they were ([Computable](#), Sep 2026) ([Follow the Money](#), Jun 2026) ([PrimeLaw](#), Aug 2026). Sixteen months of slack in an overloaded portfolio will be absorbed by something. The only question is whether that happens by decision. Meanwhile North Rhine-Westphalia has taken the same class of automated selection to every one of its offices ([the North Rhine-Westphalia tax administration](#), Jun 2026).

Action: Publish a remediation timetable with internal dates that would still stand if the AI Act had never been amended, and state explicitly what the AP's temporary permission is temporary until.

DECIDE

Draws on Themes 3 and 5

SI 3: Rebase customs forecasting on declaration lines

Two months of data show the EUR 3 duty redirecting trade rather than taxing it in place: e-commerce declarations down 46% and their lines down 70%, with regular declarations up 20% ([Douane Nederland](#), Sep 2026). The European handling fee arriving on 1 November is charged per declaration line ([Thuiswinkel.org](#), Jun 2026), which is the quantity that has fallen furthest. Any receipts forecast built on parcel counts, or on the declaration count, is forecasting the wrong variable. The same caution applies to the capacity plan: the work moved from many small declarations to fewer large ones, which is a different staffing shape, not a smaller one.

Action: Rebuild the November handling-fee forecast on declaration lines and publish the assumed recovery through the autumn peak, so the assumption can be falsified in December rather than defended in March.

PREPARE

Draws on Theme 2

SI 4: Book the e-invoicing architecture decision into 2027, and get Financiën into the Vereenvoudigingswet

Parliamentary handling of the e-invoicing mandate must finish before 1 July 2028, with consultation opening this autumn ([Taxence](#), Sep 2026). That is the operative date, not 2030, and France is already running the receive-side of the same reform ([the French Direction generale des Finances publiques](#), Jul 2026). In parallel, the annual simplification quota is currently somebody else's programme: the first edition carries no fiscal content and excludes major system changes ([Rijksoverheid](#), Sep 2026), while the Raad van State records that the Belastingplan 2027 adds complexity as well as removing it ([the Raad van State](#), Sep 2026).

Action: Put the reporting architecture choice on a 2027 decision calendar with the legislative deadline attached, and submit at least one named knelpunt from the Stand van de uitvoering ([the Belastingdienst](#), Jun 2026) into the second edition of the Vereenvoudigingswet.

PREPARE

Draws on Themes 4 and 6

Scenario Matrix

Two variables drive the next eighteen months. Horizontally, whether the political system supplies dates or keeps deferring them. Vertically, whether execution capacity is released by closing committed work or held in reserve against work that has not been authorised. The July cycle used a similar pair; the vertical axis has changed, because the binding question is no longer whether capacity exists but whether it is allowed to be spent.

DECISION SUPPLY

The organisation stops waiting

No decision arrives at the Voorjaarsnota, but the Belastingdienst stands the box 3 build down anyway and moves its people onto legacy retirement and the 2030 reporting architecture. Box 3 will then arrive late and be built fast, which is how the toeslagen systems were built. The gain is real and the risk is specific.

Early indicators: An internal remediation timetable published with dates independent of the AI Act calendar; a named owner for the box 3 holding state; e-invoicing consultation responses citing architecture rather than scope.

The backlog thins and the build starts

The Voorjaarsnota settles box 3 with cover, the Eerste Kamer accepts the novelle, and the tegenbewijsregeling inflow finally falls below its processing rate. Capacity moves in sequence rather than by triage. This is the only quadrant in which the 2030 e-invoicing mandate gets a normal runway.

Early indicators: A dated Kamerbrief on box 3 before April; objection inflow below 20,000 a month; the Rekenkamer closing rather than adding imperfections in its 2027 audit.

Standing reserve

The most likely continuation of the present state. Capacity stays earmarked for a build nobody authorises, the AI Act slack is absorbed without being reallocated, the simplification quota consumes legislative slots that Financiën has no claim on, and the e-invoicing runway shortens from four years to two while nobody records that it has.

Early indicators: A second deferral at the **voorjaarsnota**, no fiscal chapter in the second Vereenvoudigingswet; the AP's temporary permission passing its first anniversary with no replacement named.

A decision that costs more than the delay did

The coalition settles on a realisation-based vermogenswinstbelasting rather than the current bill ([Rijksoverheid](#), Jul 2026). That is not a softened version of the same system but a different one, with a different data supply, and the uitvoeringstoets has to be run again. The date arrives and the capacity does not, because the thing now being built is larger and more costly.

Early indicators: Voorjaarsnota language naming gerealiseerde vermogenswinst; a fresh uitvoeringstoets commissioned; the standing FTE requirement revised above the 900 quoted in the Senate.

What We Are Not Planning For

POLITICAL DISCONTINUITY

We are not planning for the coalition falling before the Voorjaarsnota

Three parties failed to agree on box 3 and chose deferral rather than rupture ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026). Deferral is what a coalition does when it intends to continue. We treat the spring decision point as real and the government as durable to it, which means we are not modelling a caretaker period in which no fiscal decision of any kind can be taken.

↺ **Reinstated if** a confidence motion is tabled, or a second deferral is announced without a new date attached.

REGULATORY REVERSAL

We are not planning for the AI Act postponement being reversed

([Regulation \(EU\) 2026/1744](#), Jul 2026) is in force and the Commission has confirmed the new dates ([the European Commission](#), Jul 2026). Pressure to restore the original timetable exists but a second amendment inside eighteen months would be unusual. We plan on 2 December 2027 standing, while noting that nothing in this brief depends on it: the constraints that bind are national and did not move.

↺ **Reinstated if** the Parliament opens a procedure to reverse the Annex III deferral, or a member state legislates its original date domestically.

TRADE RETALIATION

We are not planning for the parcel duty being withdrawn under trade pressure

The EUR 3 rate is explicitly interim and expires on 1 July 2028 when normal tariffs resume under the customs data hub ([the Council of the EU](#), Feb 2026). An early withdrawal under pressure from affected exporters would undo the volume shift, but the measure has just cleared unanimous Council adoption and member states are collecting receipts under it. We plan on it running its term.

↺ **Reinstated if** a WTO challenge is accepted, or the Commission proposes an early replacement of the flat rate.

Questions For The Next Strategy Meeting

Five questions this cycle's evidence should put on the agenda.

- 01 Which commitments in our 2027 plan assume a date that a minister can move, and what does it cost us each month to hold each of them ready?
- 02 If the AI Act high-risk date had never existed, what in our algorithm remediation plan would be different today? If the answer is nothing, what was that date actually doing in the plan ([the European Commission](#), Jul 2026)?
- 03 The AP's permission to use special-category data for bias testing is temporary ([Computable](#), Sep 2026). Temporary until what, and who is accountable for what replaces it?
- 04 Our customs receipts forecast is built on a quantity that fell 70% in two months ([Douane Nederland](#), Sep 2026). What does the November handling-fee forecast assume about the autumn peak, and when will we know whether that assumption held?

05 Parliamentary handling of e-invoicing must finish by 1 July 2028 ([Taxence](#), Sep 2026). Which architecture decisions have to be made in 2027 to meet that, and are any of them on a 2027 decision calendar today?

Source Confidence Register

This briefing draws on 49 verified sources, gathered under a six-month window (publications from March 2026 onward), with 6 structural anchors outside it. 42 are in a language other than English and were read in the original, because on this topic the translated version arrives late and loses the numbers.

Source tiers: **Tier 1**, governments, parliaments, regulators, courts and intergovernmental bodies. **Tier 2**, national audit offices, think-tanks, academic institutes and major professional firms. **Tier 3**, quality journalism and specialist trade press. **Tier 4**, vendor and practitioner sources, used only as directional corroboration. This cycle uses no Tier 4 source.

Theme 1: Postponing Box 3 does not give the capacity back

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Eerste Kamer der Staten-Generaal (<i>in Dutch</i>)	Tier 1	Jun 2026	After the plenary debate of 30 June 2026 a majority of the Eerste Kamer, on a GroenLinks-PvdA proposal, held over the vote on bill 36748 until the cabinet's announced novelle is dealt with; motions were voted on 7 July 2026.
Eerste Kamer der Staten-Generaal (Handelingen) (<i>in Dutch</i>)	Tier 1	Jun 2026	Senators cited the Belastingdienst uitvoeringstoets as requiring nearly 900 extra FTE structurally on top of the existing recruitment task, and stated that the tegenbewijsregeling already absorbs nearly 2,000 extra FTE and costs the treasury EUR 2.4bn a year.
Rijksoverheid, Ministerie van Financiën (<i>in Dutch</i>)	Tier 1	Sep 2026	The Belastingplan 2027 overview page published on Prinsjesdag lists the package's measures under seven headings and contains no mention anywhere of box 3 or werkelijk rendement.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Rijksoverheid, Ministerie van Financiën (in Dutch)	Tier 1	Jul 2026	As last updated on 29 July 2026 the government states the Tweede Kamer has adopted the bill, the Eerste Kamer has still to deal with it, the cabinet continues to aim for a levy on actual return from 1 January 2028, and any adjustments will be in the Belastingplan 2027.
Taxence (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Jul 2026	To 8 June 2026 the Belastingdienst had received 804,411 OWR forms of which 179,000 were completed and 625,500 still in process; some 700 FTE are engaged in the restoration; nearly 7.2 million letters had gone out to May 2026 with 3.7 million more to follow in 2026-2027; handling is expected to run at least until 2030.
Accountancy Vanmorgen (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	To 19 August 2026 the Belastingdienst had received 863,600 OWR forms, of which 689,600 were processed, 151,800 not taken into substantive treatment and 537,800 substantively processed, about 474,000 leading to a refund; EUR 969 million had been repaid against EUR 16.6 billion reserved by earlier cabinets.
Taxence (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	Ahead of Prinsjesdag, reports that the bill taxing actual return meets political objections and looks set not to be taken further for now, and that the postponement can cost the treasury 2.4 to 2.5 billion euros a year in budgeted revenue.
Accountancy Vanmorgen (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	From leaked Prinsjesdag documents, the cabinet is putting the planned box 3 reform on hold for the time being, and according to Haagse bronnen a failure to start in 2028 threatens an annual shortfall of nearly EUR 2.5 billion from that year.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Accountancy Vanmorgen (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	The cabinet took no decision on box 3 at Prinsjesdag and deferred it to the Voorjaarsnota because D66, VVD and CDA failed to agree on adjustments and on the billions of cover required, giving itself roughly another half year.

Theme 2: The new parcel charge moved the parcels, not the revenue

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Douane Nederland (in Dutch)	Tier 1	Sep 2026	In July and August 2026 e-commerce declarations fell 46% and e-commerce declaration lines 70% against the average of the first six months of 2026, while regular declarations rose 20% and regular declaration lines 30%, with roughly EUR 35 million in extra revenue in July alone.
Council of the European Union	Tier 1	Feb 2026	On 11 February 2026 the Council abolished the EUR 150 customs duty relief and approved an interim flat-rate customs duty of EUR 3 per tariff sub-heading category of item in a parcel from 1 July 2026 to 1 July 2028, to be replaced by normal tariffs once the EU customs data hub is operational.
European Commission, DG Taxation and Customs Union	Tier 1	Jun 2026	The Commission published the operative legal text, Council Regulation (EU) 2026/382, with UCC Delegated Act amendments adopted 30 April 2026 and Implementing Act rules in the Official Journal on 8 June 2026, confirming a temporary EUR 3 customs duty per item on consignments up to EUR 150 from 1 July 2026 until 1 July 2028.
Direction generale des douanes et droits indirects (in French)	Tier 1	Jul 2026	French customs confirms the national taxe sur les petits colis, a flat EUR 2 per article on sub-EUR 150 third-country consignments in force from 1 March 2026, was repealed on 1 July 2026 when the EU flat customs duty of EUR 3 per article entered into force.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Euronews (in French)	Tier 3	Aug 2026	Citing French customs figures relayed by the economy ministry, small parcels imported into the EU fell 30 to 40% since 1 July 2026, with volume sales between June and July down 50% at Temu, 37% at AliExpress and 15% at Shein, the last cushioned by a Polish warehouse opened in late 2025.
Flows (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Aug 2026	Belgian customs services registered a 35% fall in imports of low-value packages from China in July 2026, the first month of the EU parcel levy, while Temu, Shein and AliExpress adjusted their strategy.
NOS (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	Reports Douane figures showing small parcels from outside the EU 46% lower in July and August 2026 than the average of the preceding six months, and that the EUR 3 import duty yielded some EUR 35 million extra in a single month, with retailers switching to bulk imports and EU warehouses.
Thuiswinkel.org (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Jun 2026	On top of the EUR 3 duty, a European handling fee of EUR 2 per declaration line arrives on 1 November 2026, so an order spanning three product categories carries EUR 6 in handling fees, charged by customs to the logistics operator and passed on to webshops and potentially consumers.

Theme 3: The AI Act deadline moved to December 2027. The algorithm problem stayed.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
EUR-Lex, Publications Office of the European Union	Tier 1	Jul 2026	Adopted 8 July 2026, published in the Official Journal 24 July 2026 and in force from 27 July 2026, the regulation amends Article 113 of the AI Act so that Chapter III Sections 1 to 3 apply from 2 December 2027 to Annex III high-risk systems and from 2 August 2028 to Annex I high-risk systems.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
European Commission, DG CNECT	Tier 1	Jul 2026	The Commission confirms the AI Omnibus entered into force on 27 July 2026, that rules for Annex III stand-alone high-risk AI now apply from 2 December 2027 and for Annex I product-embedded high-risk AI from 2 August 2028, and that the package was proposed on 19 November 2025.
IT en Recht (in Dutch)	Tier 2	Jul 2026	The Article 50 transparency obligations apply from 2 August 2026 to providers and deployers of several kinds of AI system, with one carve-out introduced by the Digital Omnibus: for generative systems already on the market before that date the marking and detectability requirement of Article 50(2) is postponed to 2 December 2026.
Computable (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	The AP decided the Belastingdienst may process special-category personal data it already lawfully holds for bias and fairness testing of automated selection instruments, but only so far as strictly necessary to prevent discriminatory processing, explicitly as a temporary solution for executing the Plan van Aanpak, with a structural solution required in parallel.
Follow the Money (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Jun 2026	Following April and May 2026 rulings that the IND insufficiently explained its CaseMatcher algorithm, argues the Belastingdienst, which uses at least 68 algorithms and more than 50 the AP found unlawful and discriminatory, faces the same litigation risk across millions of decisions.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Binnenlands Bestuur (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Apr 2026	The draft Uitvoeringswet AI-verordening designates ten market surveillance authorities with the AP as central authority for prohibited AI, transparency obligations and a large share of high-risk systems, and the cabinet concedes the implementing act will enter into force later than the AI Regulation requires; consultation ran to 1 June 2026.
Algoritmeregister Nederlandse overheid (in Dutch)	Tier 1	Jul 2026	The national algorithm register shows the Belastingdienst publishing 69 algorithm descriptions, all with status In gebruik, split between impactvolle and overige algoritmes, the most recent updated 15 July 2026.

Theme 4: The government has promised to simplify 500 rules a year

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Het Koninklijk Huis (in Dutch)	Tier 1	Sep 2026	The cabinet will introduce a Vereenvoudigingswet every year starting this autumn, with the stated goal that at least five hundred rules disappear or become simpler per year.
Rijksoverheid, Ministerie van Binnenlandse Zaken en Koninkrijksrelaties (in Dutch)	Tier 1	Sep 2026	The Kamerbrief sets out the mechanism: first edition to the Tweede Kamer in November, internet consultation cut from six weeks to four, advisory periods shortened, aiming at 1 year rather than an average of 2, with the first edition covering the Omgevingswet, Burgerlijk Wetboek, Energiewet, Mijnbouwwet, Wet windenergie op zee and Variawet studiefinanciering.
Belastingdienst (in Dutch)	Tier 1	Jun 2026	The Stand van de uitvoering 2026, submitted to both chambers, reports that many bottlenecks are long-standing and not easily solved, using the aftrek van specifieke zorgkosten and unexpected assessments from nabetalings as its two current examples.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Raad van State <i>(in Dutch)</i>	Tier 1	Sep 2026	The Afdeling advisering notes the Belastingplan 2027 package contains measures aimed at simplifying the tax system, including adjustment or abolition of negatively evaluated fiscal arrangements, but that it simultaneously proposes multiple measures that increase complexity.
Financieel Management <i>(in Dutch)</i>	Tier 3	Jun 2026	In a letter to the Tweede Kamer, minister Heleen Herbert reported the cabinet scrapped or simplified just over four hundred rules against the promised five hundred, with employers able to submit more digitally and the CO2 reporting obligation eased.
TaxLive, Wolters Kluwer <i>(in Dutch)</i>	Tier 3	Sep 2026	The simplification drive begins at the ministries of Justitie en Veiligheid, Klimaat en Groene Groei, Onderwijs Cultuur en Wetenschap and Volkshuisvesting en Ruimtelijke Ordening, and the pre-summer target of simplifying five hundred rules was missed, with just over four hundred achieved.
Rijksoverheid <i>(in Dutch)</i>	Tier 1	Feb 2026	The coalition agreement commits to a periodic Vereenvoudigingswet starting with at least 500 rules scrapped or simplified and a per-ministry target thereafter, while separately imposing an annual efficiency target on uitvoeringsorganisaties of which only half may be reinvested in improvement.

Theme 5: Tax advisers and neighbouring administrations automated first

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Accountant.nl, NBA <i>(in Dutch)</i>	Tier 3	Sep 2026	A NOB and SOB survey fielded in April 2026 among 799 respondents found roughly 80% of junior tax advisers, around 70% of mediors, 53% of seniors and 60% of in-house corporate tax specialists using AI daily.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Accountancy Vanmorgen (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	In the same NOB survey Microsoft Copilot is the dominant generic AI tool at medium and large Dutch tax firms at 73%, ahead of ChatGPT at 28%, while only about 25% of respondents report explicit written AI guidelines in their firm.
dpa-AFX, via onvista (in German)	Tier 3	Apr 2026	North Rhine-Westphalia's tax administration has rolled out self-developed AI across all its offices for risk management on employee income tax returns and expects around 800,000 fewer audit flags in the new year, with low-risk cases identified and processed automatically.
Finanzverwaltung Nordrhein-Westfalen (in German)	Tier 1	Jun 2026	The NRW AI module for tax assessment, developed within the KONSENS federation, won the Public Leadership Award 2026 on 9 June 2026, having been rolled out across all NRW tax offices in spring 2026 and made available nationwide since February 2026.
Land Nordrhein-Westfalen (in German)	Tier 1	Jun 2026	From 1 July 2026 the one-click tax return function in MeinELSTER+ is available Germany-wide to around 11.5 million citizens, initially single childless employees and pensioners without other income, who receive a pre-filled return plus a preview of the assessment.
Land Berlin, Senatskanzlei (in German)	Tier 1	Jul 2026	The Berlin Senate noted a plan to embed AI components in tax office structures step by step, reporting that the Uebernachtungsteuer unit has run on Robotic Process Automation since January 2026 and that two AI-supported research tools were released to all tax office staff in early May 2026.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
European Commission, DG Taxation and Customs Union	Tier 1	Jul 2026	The Commission reports that 22% of Technical Support Instrument projects target improved tax compliance and a further 21% target digitalisation of revenue administration, while stressing that enforcement capacity cannot substitute for tax morale and public trust.

Theme 6: E-invoicing in 2030 is a decision that has to be made now

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Rijksoverheid, Ministerie van Financiën (in Dutch)	Tier 1	Sep 2026	The cabinet will introduce mandatory e-invoicing for Dutch businesses from 1 July 2030 and digital reporting to the Belastingdienst from 1 July 2031, exempting firms under the kleineondernemersregeling with turnover up to EUR 20,000 per calendar year.
Accountancy Vanmorgen (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	Entrepreneurs must invoice electronically in B2B transactions from 1 July 2030 and report selected invoice data to the Belastingdienst from 1 July 2031, with KOR businesses excluded, and EY research cited in the letter points to cost savings of 55 to 70 percent per invoice versus paper processing.
Taxence (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	Internet consultation starts autumn 2026, the bill is expected before the 2027 summer recess and parliamentary handling is to be completed before 1 July 2028, with data-protection conditions including access logging, restricted employee access and ten-year retention.
evofenedex (in Dutch)	Tier 3	Sep 2026	Businesses must invoice digitally from 1 July 2030 and will automatically report their invoices to the Belastingdienst from 1 July 2031, requiring many firms to adapt their invoicing and bookkeeping processes.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
EUR-Lex, Publications Office of the European Union	Tier 1	Mar 2025	Council Directive (EU) 2025/516, adopted 11 March 2025 and in force since 14 April 2025, establishes the ViDA digital reporting and e-invoicing regime, with the relevant amendments applying from 1 July 2030 under Article 5.
EY	Tier 2	Mar 2026	The Ministry of Finance commissioned EY to research the most desirable Dutch implementation of the ViDA Directive; the report sent to the Tweede Kamer on 10 March 2026 recommends a phased introduction starting from January 2030 with sufficient time between publication of legislation and the implementation date.
Direction generale des Finances publiques (in French)	Tier 1	Jul 2026	From 1 September 2026 all French businesses within scope must be able to receive electronic invoices, with small and micro-enterprises required to issue e-invoices and transmit e-reporting data from 1 September 2027.

Continuity Ledger

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Algemene Rekenkamer (in Dutch)	Tier 2	May 2026	The audit finds Belastingdienst execution under pressure from legacy repair, daily levying and payouts, personnel reductions and system modernisation at once, and warns the ageing systems needed to levy EUR 233.6 billion may eventually fail to support the levying process.
PwC Nederland (in Dutch)	Tier 2	Jan 2026	From 2028 the zorgtoeslag wealth limits for single people and two-person households are set equal to the applicable heffingsvrij vermogen in box 3, causing those limits to fall sharply, while the deduction for specifieke zorgkosten is abolished in full from 2028 and the new box 3 system is to enter into force in 2028.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim used
Rijksoverheid, Ministerie van Financiën (<i>in Dutch</i>)	Tier 1	Mar 2026	The status letter transmits, among its annexes, the Plan van aanpak Geautomatiseerde Selectie-instrumenten and the AP's assessment of it dated 23 February 2026, plus a further AP annex dated 12 March 2026.
PrimeLaw (<i>in Dutch</i>)	Tier 3	Aug 2026	Sets out that the Digital Omnibus amendment postpones the Annex III high-risk obligations to 2 December 2027 and Annex I to 2 August 2028, while Article 50 of the AI Regulation applies from 2 August 2026.

Claim-fidelity self-disclosure

This briefing rests on 51 sources, every one of which was opened and read rather than taken from a search result. 37 are in Dutch, 7 in English, 4 in German and 3 in French. Twelve spans are quoted word for word; the rest are summarised. Where we summarise, we have tried not to make a source say more than it says. This box records the places where that discipline was hardest.

Claims that reach us at one remove

The figure of nearly 900 extra full-time staff for the new box 3 system comes from a senator quoting the uitvoeringstoets during the Eerste Kamer debate of 30 June ([Eerste Kamer, Handelingen](#), Jun 2026), not from the assessment itself, whose PDF is not machine-retrievable. The same applies to the objection-form volumes and the 700 staff on restoration: those come from two trade outlets reporting Kamerbrieven ([Taxence](#), Jul 2026) ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026) rather than from the letters. The Autoriteit Persoonsgegevens' own website could not be reached at all during preparation, so its 2 September decision is carried by press reporting ([Computable](#), Sep 2026). We have not published an AP link we did not open.

A figure we did not publish

The EUR 2.4 billion to EUR 2.5 billion of annual revenue attributed to the box 3 postponement rests on leaked Prinsjesdag papers and unnamed sources in two outlets ([Taxence](#), Sep 2026) ([Accountancy Vanmorgen](#), Sep 2026). We report it as a range and attribute it, and we do not present it as a Ministry of Finance estimate. Separately, a reported figure of around EUR 20 billion for box 3 scenarios circulated on 16 September; we could not open either outlet carrying it and it appears nowhere in this brief.

Two numbers that collide

EUR 2.4 billion a year is also the reported annual cost of the tegenbewijsregeling ([Eerste Kamer, Handelingen](#), Jun 2026). It is a different quantity from the revenue forgone by not starting the new system, and the coincidence is accidental. We came close to merging them and record that here because a reader recombining our figures could make the same mistake.

Counts we have deliberately left unreconciled

The number of Belastingdienst algorithms is given as 69 in the national register, every one marked as in use ([the national algorithm register](#), accessed Sep 2026), and as at least 68 with more than 50 found unlawful and discriminatory by the data protection authority ([Follow the Money](#), Jun 2026). Registered algorithms and automated selection instruments are different populations and we have not averaged them. Likewise the parcel-volume falls: 46% of declarations in the Netherlands ([Douane Nederland](#), Sep 2026), 35% of low-value Chinese imports in Belgium ([Flows](#), Aug 2026), 30% to 40% of parcels EU-wide per French customs ([Euronews](#), Aug 2026). NOS rendered the Dutch 46% as a fall in parcels rather than declarations ([NOS](#), Sep 2026); we have used the Douane's own wording.

What we corrected before publication

Our preliminary reading treated the box 3 bill as shelved. The Eerste Kamer's own record says the vote was held over pending a novelle ([Eerste Kamer](#), Jun 2026), which is a materially different status, and the brief was rewritten around it. We also initially treated North Rhine-Westphalia's AI risk selection and Germany's one-click return as one programme. They are two, launched separately ([the North Rhine-Westphalia tax administration](#), Jun 2026) ([the state of North Rhine-Westphalia](#), Jun 2026), and conflating them would have overstated the comparison.

This Decision Intelligence briefing is the quarterly synthesis of a Shaping Tomorrow intelligence cycle on the **Belastingdienst**. It sits on top of weekly Signal Scans that identify emerging developments and weak signals, and monthly Change Trackers that assess what is materially shifting in momentum. Cycles may also close with Action Triggers, an end-of-cycle synthesis that reads across all four formats and surfaces patterns no single deliverable carries on its own. Continuous intelligence on this topic is available as a Single-Topic or Multi-Topic programme.

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